

COUNTABLE/UNCOUNTABLE NOUNS

Countable nouns are those that can be counted. They have singular and plural forms (one peach, two peaches, etc.).

Uncountable nouns are those that cannot be counted (milk, flour, etc.).

Uncountable nouns take a singular verb and are not used with a/an.

These are:

types of food (bread, cheese, etc.), **liquids** (water, petrol, etc.), **subjects of study** (History, Chemistry, etc.), **languages** (English, Portuguese, etc.), **sports** (tennis, baseball, etc.)

diseases (malaria, flu, etc.), **natural phenomena** (rain, fog, etc.), **certain nouns** (advice, dirt, education, luck, news, peace, traffic, weather, homework, music, information, seaside, shopping, trouble, work, etc.), **collective nouns** (furniture, money, rubbish, jewelry, luggage, etc.)

We can use both uncountable nouns and countable nouns after **phrases of quantity** such as; a **jar/bottle/piece/loaf/cup/glass/kilo/carton/bowl/can/tin/slice/packet of, etc.**

She ate two slices of bread. I need a kilo of tomatoes.

Some/Any/No			
Affirmative			
Adjectives	Pronouns		Adverbs
	people	things	places
some	someone/ somebody	something	somewhere
any	anyone/ anybody	anything	anywhere

Some and its **compounds** (someone, something, etc.) are normally used in positive sentences. They can also be used in **questions** to make an **offer**, a **request** or when we expect a **positive answer**.

I bought some books yesterday. (positive)

Would you like something to drink? (offer)

Can I have something to eat? (request)

Any and its **compounds** (anyone, anything, etc.) are normally used in **questions** and **negations**.

There aren't any apples left. (negation)

Is there anything I can make for the party? (question)

! They can also be used in **positive** sentences **1)** meaning “**It doesn't matter how/what/when/where/which/who, etc.**”

You can ask anybody to go with you. (= it doesn't matter who)

2) Any and its **compounds** can be used after **if in a positive sentence**.

If you need anything, please tell me.

3) They are also used with **negative words** (**hardly, never, without, seldom, rarely, etc.**)

She never goes out with anyone from work. (NOT: She never goes out with ~~no one~~ from work.)

Some/Any/No			
Negative			
Adjectives	Pronouns		Adverbs
	people	things	places
no/ not any	no one/ not anyone nobody/not anybody	nothing/ not anything	nowhere/ not anywhere

No/Not any and their **compounds** (no one/not anyone, nothing/not anything, etc.) are used in **negations**.

There is no milk. (= There isn't any milk.)

There's no one in the house. (= There isn't anyone in the house.)

MUCH/MANY

Much and many are normally used in **questions** and **negations**.

Much is used with uncountable nouns and many is used with plural countable nouns.

There isn't much coffee in the jar. Have you got many books?

How much and how many are used in **questions**.

How much + uncountable noun = amount

How many + countable noun = number

How much sugar do we need? Not much.

How many people came to the party? Twenty.

A FEW/FEW/A LITTLE/LITTLE

We use few (= not many, almost none)/a few (=some/not many) with **plural** countable nouns.

Few people liked the performance. (= almost none)

I've got a few oranges. (= a small number, not many)

We use little (= not much, almost none)/a little (= some/not much) with **uncountable** nouns.

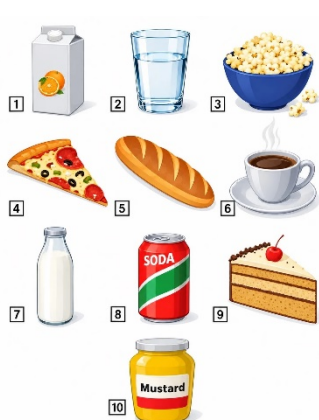
There is little milk left. (= almost none)

I'd like a little sugar in my coffee, please. (= not much)

1 Fill in the gaps with is, are, a or some.

- | | |
|--|--|
| 1 Physics my favourite subject. | 6 The traffic terrible in the city centre. |
| 2 The fog very thick, I can't see. | 7 Apples my least favourite fruit. |
| 3 The weather nice today. | 8 The furniture in storage until the new house is ready. |
| 4 Where the milk? | 9 I've got good news. |
| 5 Let me give you advice. | 10 I need loaf of bread. |

2 Fill in the gaps with an appropriate noun to indicate quantity, then make sentences, as in the example.



I'd like a carton of orange juice, please

- water
- popcorn.
- pizza
- bread
- coffee
- milk
- soda
- cake
- mustard

3 Fill in the gaps with **some, any, no** or one of their **compounds**, as in the example.

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1 A: How was your skiing weekend? | B: Terrible! There was hardly <u>any</u> snow on the mountains. |
| 2 A: There are really fascinating exhibits at the new museum. | B: Really! I must go. |
| 3 A: Hurry up! There's time to waste. The bus will be here soon. | B: I'm nearly ready. |
| 4 A: Did you visit Henry today? | B: No. When I called his house answered the phone. |
| 5 A: Do you want to go to the cinema tonight? | B: No, thanks. There's I want to see. |
| 6 A: Can I get you from the shop? | B: Just a bag of crisps, thanks. |
| 7 A: I bought great books from the book fair this afternoon. | B: Really! Let me see. |
| 8 A: I've always wanted to go exotic for my holidays. | B: Why don't you go to Tahiti, then? |

4 Underline the correct word.

- | | |
|--|--|
| 1 Somebody/Anybody broke into our house last night. | 5 Nobody/Somebody is allowed to park in front of this building. |
| 2 I had any/no time to go to the post office today. | 6 Have I done something/nothing to offend you? |
| 3 Are you going nowhere/anywhere nice for your holidays? | 7 If no one/anyone is looking for me, tell them I've gone home. |
| 4 There was anyone/no one left at the party by two o'clock. | 8 It'll take you any/some time to get used to such a hot climate. |

5 Fill in the gaps with How many or How much, as in the example.

- | | | | |
|---------------------------|-------------------|------------------|--------------------|
| 1 <u>How much</u> yogurt? | 6 pepper? | 11 glue? | 16 paper? |
| 2 coffee? | 7 biscuits? | 12 cheese? | 17 cherries? |
| 3 books? | 8 cabbage? | 13 keys? | 18 milk? |
| 4 potatoes? | 9 onions? | 14 apples? | 19 mustard? |
| 5 soap? | 10 pens? | 15 water? | 20 popcorn? |

6 Fill in much/many/ how many/how much

- A: Let's make lasagne for the dinner party tomorrow.
 B: Great idea! 1) How much minced meat do we need?
- A: Not 2) Half a kilo will do.
 B: OK. 3) tomatoes?
- A: About three big ones.
 B: 4) cheese should I buy?
- A: Get about half a kilo of mozzarella.
 B: Right. Now, 5) packets of lasagne will we need?
- A: One packet will be enough.
 B: What about onions? We haven't got 6) left.
- A: We only need two. Is there any milk in the fridge?
 B: Well, there is some but not 7)

A: You'd better buy a carton then. And get some flour as well.

B: 8) flour shall I buy?

A: A small packet will be enough.

B: OK. I'll be back in about an hour.

7 Fill in the gaps with a few or a little, as in the example.

1 A: What would you like in your coffee?

B: Just a little sugar, please.

2 A: Are you going to buy that jacket you saw last week?

B: No. I've only got money left so I can't afford it.

3 A: Could I have more ice cubes in my drink?

B: Certainly.

4 A: There are still tickets left for the concert on Friday night.

B: Great. I'll go and buy one now.

5 A: Only people know that Karen used to be a famous ballet dancer.

B: Really? I had no idea.

6 A: This curry isn't spicy.

B: Wee, why don't you add curry powder to it?

8 Fill in: a little/little or a few/few

1 Spending hours in the sun every day is pleasant.

2 We have been to the Greek islands times.

3 There were very people in the taverna last night.

4 Would you like milk in your coffee?

5 I'd like to spend more time on the beach today.

6 He has patience for rude customers.

7 Let's see if there's coffee left in the pot.

8 There's so coffee, we'll have to make more.

9 Correct the mistakes in these sentences. Use a lot of, many or much.

a They don't have much people here.

b How many does it cost?

c The hotel doesn't have much rooms left.

d I don't drink many coffee.

e I drink much tea.

10 Fill in: much, many, lots of, a lot of, little, most, a little, little, a few, few.

1 It seems we have had assignments in English this year.

2 How do we have to read this week?

3 Americans don't like George Bush

4 There aren't very books in the library.

5 I think he drank wine last night.

6 I have had headaches already because of the stress.

7 It has rained very this summer, that's why the grass is so brown.

8 people know as much about computers as Jack does.

9 I'm having trouble passing my driving test.

10 I do have friends but not that many.

11 How juice is left in the bottle?

12 John had money with him so he couldn't even buy a bus ticket.

13 time and money is spent on education in Great Britain.

14 I know Spanish so I am going to have a problem when I get there.

15 of the children in our block have got roller skates.

16 Football is the only subject I know very of. It doesn't interest me that much.

17 people can live without money. We simply need it.

18 There are leftovers for you in the refrigerator.

19 Is she already gone? – I'm only minutes late.

20 There is doubt that Anne will win the contest.

21 There is not very dancing going on at the party.

22 people in the city ride a bike to work because you are simply faster.